

Elie-Andre Disso

Graduate AI Engineer at Fifty One Degrees and PhD researcher in Artificial Intelligence at the University of Westminster. My experience spans Python engineering, language-model evaluation, computer vision and NLP, alongside stakeholder-led AI development and end-to-end personal projects.

elie.disso@gmail.com · LinkedIn · GitHub

Experience

FIFTY ONE DEGREES · OCTOBER 2026-PRESENT

Graduate AI Engineer

Applied AI engineering and client delivery, alongside my PhD research.

NATWEST GROUP · JUNE-AUGUST 2026

Engineering Intern

- Contributed to the design and development of an internal AI decision-support tool in an intern Scrum team, translating stakeholder needs into criteria covering cost, scalability and technical risk.
- Contributed to solution-design diagrams using Visio and learned to set up and use Jira workflows.
- Proposed a Power BI analytics architecture connecting Copilot Studio, Power Automate and Dataverse to track usage, recurring questions and user feedback. This was a design proposal, not a deployed analytics system.
- Completed an individual research project on AI-assisted scam prevention, recommending a controlled Outlook add-in or browser-extension pilot for analysing suspicious messages and links.
- Built a Java application during an engineering activity and ran a Dynamic Application Security Testing scan using OWASP ZAP.
- Participated in a five-hour Microsoft low-code hackathon involving two teams.

Engineering learning: Kubernetes and Amazon EKS, Terraform, Helm and GitOps; CI/CD, observability with Grafana and OpenTelemetry, and testing and security practices.

THE ALAN TURING INSTITUTE · JUNE-DECEMBER 2024

Machine Learning Researcher Intern - LLM Systems

- Built automated language-model evaluation workflows using Python and OpenAI APIs.
- Designed experiments comparing model outputs across summarisation and reasoning tasks, using structured criteria for factuality, relevance and fluency.
- Investigated prompt optimisation, including few-shot prompting, and analysed outputs to identify recurring failure patterns.
- Engineered reproducible workflows for comparing outputs across model architectures and prompting approaches.

UNIVERSITY OF WESTMINSTER · JANUARY 2023-EXPECTED MAY 2027

PhD Researcher - Artificial Intelligence

- Designed and implemented machine-learning pipelines for structured data analysis and prediction.
- Built predictive models with scikit-learn, including data preprocessing and feature-engineering workflows.
- Applied statistical validation to assess model reliability and support reproducible experiments.
- Research interests span computer vision, NLP and machine-learning applications related to food waste.

Technical skills

Programming - Python, SQL, Bash, R; Java through an internship engineering activity.

Machine learning - PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, Hugging Face, fastai and OpenCV; preprocessing, feature engineering, experimental design and statistical validation.

Language models - OpenAI and Claude APIs, prompt engineering, model benchmarking, structured evaluation and document-processing workflows.

Applications & data - REST APIs, Flask, React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, data pipelines and structured extraction.

Engineering tools - Git, Linux and Docker; Jira and Visio; OWASP ZAP through an internship security-testing activity.

Platform familiarity - Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, Terraform, Helm, GitOps, CI/CD, Grafana and OpenTelemetry - learning and exposure during the NatWest internship.

Selected projects

COMPUTER VISION · RESEARCH PROTOTYPE

Food-image classification

Implemented a Flask upload endpoint that decodes an image, resizes it to 256×256 , normalises the pixels and runs inference with a saved Keras model. The local prototype returns a food / non-food prediction as JSON.

COMPUTER VISION · PERSONAL PROJECT

German car classifier

Developed an image-classification experiment with a training notebook, an exported model and an application for trying predictions. The public repository includes the implementation and sample images.

[View source code](#)

LANGUAGE MODELS · PERSONAL PROJECT

LLM-powered document extraction

Built a backend for parsing documents using language models and PDF-processing pipelines. Extracts tables, entities and metadata into structured CSV or SQL outputs, with support for web and PDF ingestion and chunked processing.

LANGUAGE MODELS · RESEARCH PROJECT

Comparative language-model evaluation

Compared proprietary and open-source models on summarisation and reasoning tasks. Used structured criteria for factuality, fluency and contextual relevance, investigated prompting strategies and analysed recurring output failures.

PLATFORM · PRIVATE PROJECT IN DEVELOPMENT

Quant

Developing a modular quantitative research platform spanning market data, strategy experiments, backtesting, portfolio analysis and risk controls. Work includes momentum and mean-reversion strategies, transaction costs and slippage, portfolio metrics and paper-trading workflows.

Private project in development; public overview only.

PLATFORM · INTERNAL BUSINESS OPERATIONS

Leapmind OS

End-to-end development of an internal CRM and operations platform using React, Node.js, PostgreSQL and Docker. Connects prospect management, communication history, follow-ups and calendar workflows, with role-based permissions and server-side pagination.

An internal platform; code and business records remain private.

Education and languages

PhD, Artificial Intelligence - in progress

University of Westminster · January 2023-expected May 2027

MSc, Immunology

University of Westminster · 2021-2022

BSc, Biomedical Sciences

University of Westminster · 2018-2021

Languages

English and French - native

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elie.disso@gmail.com · [LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#)